Web Development for Beginners

1. Summary of Project

Name of Individual: R.V.Vihanga Rathmalgoda
Name of Project: Web Development for Beginners
Country: Sri Lanka
Site(s)/Location(s): American Corner Matara Lab
Type(s) and Number of Beneficiaries: Direct – 35 youth participants (ages 16–25)
Proposed Program Dates: January 2026 – April 2026 (3 months)
Primary Field Point of Contact and Title: R.V.Vihanga Rathmalgoda
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Funding Amount Requested (in USD): 780

Project Goal

To empower 35 youth aged 16–25 in Southern Sri Lanka with strong, practical skills in modern web development through hands-on training in HTML, CSS, Bootstrap, and PHP. The program aims to foster **innovation, employability, and entrepreneurship** by using **American-style technology education** tools and teaching methods that emphasize **project-based learning, creativity, and problem-solving**.

Through this course, participants will gain the technical confidence and professional readiness to pursue freelance work, internships, or entry-level web development roles—building a foundation for Sri Lanka's growing digital economy.

Program Objectives

1. Introduce students to core web development languages and tools (HTML, CSS, Bootstrap, and PHP) through structured, hands-on sessions.
2. Provide practical coding experience using **American tools** such as **Visual Studio Code**, **XAMPP**, and **MySQL**, following best practices in American web development education.
3. Enable participants to build complete, database-driven web applications and understand the **full deployment workflow** from development to hosting.
4. Strengthen problem-solving and design thinking skills through mini-projects and collaborative exercises.
5. Foster **youth empowerment and employability** through career guidance, portfolio development, and digital literacy training.

2. Problem Statement

A. Analysis

The Southern Province of Sri Lanka faces limited access to modern, practical IT education that aligns with global industry standards. Many youth complete school or university with theoretical IT exposure but lack employable technical skills—particularly in web development, which is one of the most in-demand freelance and digital career paths globally.

At the same time, Sri Lanka's youth unemployment rate remains high, and digital freelancing has become a viable alternative career path. However, without exposure to real coding environments and structured mentorship, most young learners struggle to start.

This project addresses this gap by delivering affordable, American-inspired technical training—focused on project-based learning, creativity, and collaboration—to help youth develop marketable, practical web skills.

B. Profile of the Target Population

- **Target Group:** 35 youth aged 16–25 from Matara and neighboring areas.
- **Background:** School leavers, university students, and unemployed youth with basic computer literacy but limited coding experience.
- **Selection:** Participants will be selected based on interest, motivation, and basic IT familiarity. Efforts will be made to ensure gender balance and inclusion of underrepresented youth.
- **Need:** Participants often lack access to affordable structured web training or mentoring in modern technologies.

3. Program Description

The "Web Development for Beginners" program is a 12-session, 3-month training initiative that provides youth with a strong foundation in front-end and back-end web development using HTML, CSS, Bootstrap, and PHP. Each session is 4 hours long, combining 70% practical coding exercises and 30% theory. The course begins with an environment setup (Visual Studio Code, XAMPP, MySQL) and gradually builds toward developing complete, database-driven web applications. Participants will work individually and in small groups to complete a final project that integrates all learned technologies.

Key Learning Components:

• **Environment Setup** – Installing and configuring Visual Studio Code, XAMPP, and MySQL.
• **HTML & CSS** – Structuring and styling webpages using modern standards.
• **Bootstrap** – Implementing responsive and user-friendly designs.
• **PHP & MySQL** – Building dynamic, data-driven web applications.
• **Final Project** – Creating a full website combining all technologies learned.

All sessions will be conducted at the American Corner Matara Lab, utilizing its technical facilities and learning resources.

Course Plan : click here

4. Organizational Profile

The project will be implemented by an independent facilitator with experience in web development, training, and youth capacity building. The facilitator will design all instructional materials, manage course delivery, and ensure hands-on engagement for all participants. No partner organizations are involved.

5. Performance Indicators and Monitoring Plan

Performance Indicators:

• 35 participants trained in web development tools and techniques.

• 80% of participants complete a functional web project.

• 90% satisfaction rate measured via post-course feedback.

Indicator	Target	Verification Method
Participants enrolled	35	Attendance sheet
Course completion rate	≥ 90%	Attendance + evaluation reports
Participants developing a full website	≥ 80%	Project reviews
Participant satisfaction	≥ 90%	End-of-course survey
Gender balance	40–60%	Enrollment records

Monitoring Plan:

• Attendance and progress tracked per session.

• Mid-course feedback survey to assess satisfaction and identify challenges.

• End-of-program evaluation assessing knowledge gain, coding proficiency, and confidence.

• Final showcase assessed by facilitator and American Corner staff for innovation and presentation quality.

• Post-course follow-up (3 months later) to track continued use of learned skills.

6. Sustainability Plan

The project is designed to create **long-term impact beyond the funding period**:

- Participants will receive digital copies of course materials and recordings for self-study.
- A **community coding group** will be formed (WhatsApp/Discord) for ongoing support, peer help, and knowledge sharing.
- Graduates will be encouraged to volunteer in future batches as assistant mentors, sustaining the initiative locally.
- Course materials will be open-source, allowing reuse by American Corner staff or local educators.
- Participants will be guided on how to apply their skills for **freelance opportunities** using global platforms.

7. Amplification Plan

The project's visibility and impact will be enhanced through:

- **Community showcase event** featuring student projects, inviting parents, educators, and local business representatives.
- **Press and local media coverage** coordinated with American Corner Matara.
- **Participant-generated content** (short video clips, screenshots, mini blogs) to showcase learning journeys online.

8. U.S. Government Recognition

All materials, slides, and certificates will feature the U.S. Embassy and American Corner Matara logos. The facilitator will publicly acknowledge U.S. Embassy support during the program introduction and final showcase session.